

HOW WE ZEROED IN ON THE FUNDS

► **Universe and sources:** Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi)-defined mutual fund categories were evaluated and funds were compared within the same category. The universe includes all currently active open-ended schemes with a minimum three-year history (one-two years for debt funds). Net Asset Value (NAV), expense and portfolio data are from the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI), scheme disclosures, Sebi filings, and asset management companies' (AMCs') factsheets. All returns are based on Direct Plan–Growth NAVs to standardise costs. **Data cut-off:** September 30, 2025 for performance and August 31, 2025 for portfolio data.

► **Evaluation criteria:** Rolling returns were taken (not point-to-point) to capture behaviour across market cycles. Returns are post-fee (embedded in NAV), pre-tax from an investor perspective.

Equity and hybrid funds: Monthly rolling returns over three-year and five-year windows.

Debt funds: Weekly rolling returns over one-and-a-half-year and three-year windows.

Index funds tracking Sensex, Nifty 50 or Nifty Next 50 indices, with a minimum history of one-year are considered.

SCORING PILLARS

Performance & consistency — Fund return vs category peers, and persistence across cycles.

Risk and drawdown — Volatility, absolute losses and underperformance over a risk-free guaranteed investment.

Costs and capacity — Expense ratio percentile, and assets under management (AUM) screens to measure stability/impact.

Team and process — Manager tenure & stability, and governance flags.

► **Quality controls:** We apply survivorship screens, exclude strategy/share-class duplicates, cap outlier influence, and run manual audits on any score.

► **Disclosure and independence:** No AMC paid for inclusion or ranking; no previews were shared. Rankings were an education tool, not recommendations. Investors should align choices with goals, asset allocation, risk capacity, and taxes.

METHODOLOGY FOR TOP FUND MANAGERS

► **Universe:** Fund managers across actively managed schemes were evaluated. The universe includes managers of all currently active open-ended equity & debt schemes except liquid, overnight, ultra short duration, low duration and money market.

► **Eligibility:** Fund managers with minimum fund management tenure of three years in the respective asset class were considered, subject to meeting the following AUM threshold:

EQUITY: ₹5,000 CRORE

DEBT: ₹2,500 CRORE

► **Evaluation criteria:** Rolling returns over two time periods were evaluated to capture behaviours across market cycles—one-and-a-half-year and three-year. Returns are post-fee (embedded in NAV), pre-tax from an investor perspective.

► **Disclosure and independence:** No AMC paid for inclusion or ranking; no previews were shared.

DATA DEFINITIONS FOR SCORECARD

► **Value Research Fund Rating:** Value Research fund rating is based on risk-adjusted performance. The rating of a fund vis-à-vis other funds in its category was determined by its Composite Score (derived after subtracting a fund's Risk Score from its Return Score).

For equity and hybrid funds, the Composite Score for 36 months (40% weight) and 60 months (60% weight) were combined to arrive at the Final Score. For debt funds, the Final Score was usually based on 18 months (40%) and 36 months (60%).